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Location

Büttels 3, 6811 Göfis, AT

Building Type

former retail space

Reuse

multifunctional meeting place
(library, café, events, etc.)

Usable Area

~ 250 m²

Investment Costs

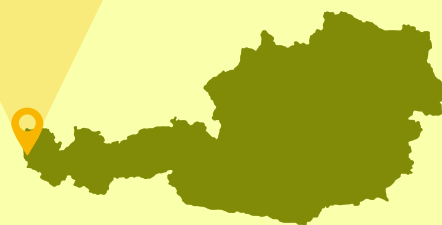
~ 500,000 €

Governance Model

municipality (*main operator*) + parish

Time until Opening

~ 5-6 years (*development & implementation*) - Opening in 2012



Initial Situation

- **The municipality of Göfis** developed into a **residential & commuter village** - the town centre **lost footfall & quality of stay**
- **Hardly any local businesses** - risk of becoming a "dormitory village"
- The **municipality** strategically **acquired buildings** in the town centre over several decades
- **Former retail space** partly vacant, in poor structural conditions
- **Library already located in the building**
- **Demand for** a meeting place, café, cultural activities & **revitalisation of the town centre**

Objectives

- **Revitalisation of the town centre** & creation of a lively meeting place
- **Promotion of social interaction** & intergenerational use
- **Strengthening local identity** through the integration of regional products & initiatives
- **Low-threshold access** to education, culture & social exchange
- **Improvement of the overall quality of life** in the municipality

Reuse Strategy

Strategy: participatory development of a multifunctional place with a strong common-good orientation

Spatial programme:

- Modern library
- Café as a meeting place (*no obligation to consume*)
- Interior spaces, flexibly usable for events
- Retail area for local products ("*Handgemacht*")

Key Decisions:

- Combination of multiple uses
- Strong involvement of the local community (*working groups, participatory processes*)
- Low-threshold access for all population groups
- Extension through outdoor spaces (*square & garden*)

Financing & Costs

- **Total renovation** ~ 500,000 €
- Implementation through public funding & subsidies (*especially LEADER*)
- Annual costs including operating costs ~ 30,000 € per year

Funding components:

- Municipality (*main funding source*)
- LEADER funding (*multiple project phases*)
- Sponsorship (~ 10,000 € per year for events)
- Loans (e.g. for café infrastructure)

Revenue sources: café operations, sale of local products, sponsorship, events

Operating Concept

- **Operation:** combination of a public institution & association-based structures
- **Use concept:** library + café + events + sale of local products
- **Social meeting place** for all population groups (including vulnerable groups)
- **Goal:** a lively village centre with a high quality of stay
- **Special feature:** no obligation to consume in the café
- **Marketing:** local media, print media, website, newsletter, word of mouth

Challenges & Solutions

- **Challenge: low footfall in the town centre**
 - *Solution: multifunctional use concept*
- **Challenge: long project development phase**
 - *Solution: step-by-step process with participation & political coordination*
- **Challenge: economic viability of operation**
 - *Solution: combination of public funding, own operation & sponsorship*
- **Challenge: structural condition & existing building stock**
 - *Solution: partial renovation + extension instead of full refurbishment*

Key Actors

- **Main operator:** Municipality of Göfis
- **Additional operator:** Parish of Göfis (St. Luzius)
- **Supporting actors:** sponsors, local businesses, community (e.g. *voluntary engagement*)
- **Users:** broad population (*all generations*)

Transferability

What makes this example particularly instructive?

- Demonstrates **successful revitalisation** of a town centre **through multifunctional use**
- Shows the **impact of early & broad citizen participation**
- Highlights the **importance of a low-threshold, open meeting place**
- Illustrates how the **public sector can actively shape** property development

Who is this model suitable for?

- Municipalities with vacant buildings in the town centre
- Places with low footfall & limited quality of stay
- Projects with a strong common-good orientation
- Initiatives primarily driven by public actors

Tips

- ✓ Choose **a location** deliberately **in the town centre**
- ✓ **Develop a mix of uses** (*interaction + services + activities*)
- ✓ Ensure **low-threshold access** (e.g. *no obligation to consume*)
- ✓ Actively **involve local actors** & regional products
- ✓ **Develop** the project **gradually & over the long term**
- ✓ **Keep offers affordable & suitable** for everyday use
- ✗ Make the project **too exclusive** or high-threshold
- ✗ Plan **uses in isolation** (*without combination*)
- ✗ **Underestimate the importance of central locations**
- ✗ Follow rigid **concepts without further development**
- ✗ **Fail to involve local actors**



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